The Haunted Network: Teacher Facilitation Guide

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The Haunted Network is a two-day, Halloween-themed review game covering all of AP Cybersecurity Unit 1 (Topics 1.1-1.5). Students work through 6 rooms and 47 challenges, then submit a PDF report on Canvas.

Overview

Students apply Unit 1 knowledge to new situations instead of recalling definitions. Each room is built on its CED scenario (1A-1E), and every challenge is tagged with its learning objective so the PDF report doubles as an LO-level diagnostic.

Room	Night / Day	Topic	Learning objectives	Challenges	Auto-scored points	Written
The Phantom Postmaster	1	1.1 Understanding Social Engineering	1.1.A, 1.1.B, 1.1.C	8	70	1
The Crypt of Cracked Credentials	1	1.2 Suspicious Website Logins	1.2.A, 1.2.B, 1.2.C	8	70	1
The Fog-Bound Cafe	1	1.3 Best Practices for Public Networks	1.3.A, 1.3.B, 1.3.C	9	80	1
The Doppelganger's Call	2	1.4 AI-Based Cybersecurity Attacks	1.4.A, 1.4.B	9	80	1
The Watchtower	2	1.5 Leveraging AI in Cyber Defense	1.5.A, 1.5.B	7	60	1
The Midnight Gauntlet	2	Mixed final review	1.1-1.5 + vocabulary	6	50	1
Total				**47**	**410**	**6 (24 pts)**

Skills practiced: Analyze Risk (Skill 1), Mitigate Risk (Skill 2), Detect Attacks (Skill 3: log hunts and indicator-of-compromise triage).

Materials: one device per student with a current browser, the game file (The-Haunted-Network-Game.html), a projector with speakers for the intro video, a Canvas assignment that accepts PDF uploads, and this guide.

Setup (10 minutes, before Day 1):

1. Get the game to students. Post The-Haunted-Network-Game.html in Canvas (Files or a Module) and have students download it and open it in Chrome or Edge. It is one self-contained file with the video and PDF builder inside, so it needs no account or install. If you received a claude.ai link instead, the owner must share it before students can open it.
2. Watch the intro video on the start screen once to check the audio level in your room. Then play through one room and download a test PDF from Results & PDF, so you know what students will see. The video is also available as an MP4 file to post on Canvas or play offline.
3. Create the Canvas assignment: PDF upload, 434 points possible (410 auto-scored + 24 written), or convert to your own scale.
4. Test the PDF download once on a student device before Day 1. Partial reports only show correct answers for questions already submitted, so checkpoint PDFs don't leak the key.

Day-by-day plan

Each day fits a 50-minute period: a 5-minute launch, about 35 minutes of play, and a 10-minute debrief. Adjust the play block for longer periods.

Day 1: Night 1 (Rooms 1-3)

Time	What happens	Teacher moves
0-5 min	Hook and launch	Play the 1 min 40 s intro video on the opening screen for the whole class (captions are built in). Then say: "Every ghost in this house is a real attack from Unit 1. Your job is to recognize it, explain it, and stop it." Students sign the guest book with full name and period.

Time	What happens	Teacher moves
5-40 min	Play Rooms 1, 2, 3 in order	Circulate. Watch for students rushing the log hunt and hotspot email; remind them that flagging normal items costs points. Prompt struggling students to reread the briefing scenario.
40-48 min	Debrief	Project the Room 2 log. Ask: "Which rows did you flag, and which were you tempted to flag but didn't?" Draw out the difference between one typo at home (rows 9-10) and the 3 AM burst.
48-50 min	Checkpoint	Students open Results & PDF and confirm their Night 1 rooms show as answered. Then every student clicks Download save file or Copy resume code in the orange box on the House map and puts it in their email or Google Drive. This is the fail-safe if they land on a different computer tomorrow. Optional: download a Day 1 checkpoint PDF.

Day 2: Night 2 (Rooms 4-6)

Time	What happens	Teacher moves
0-5 min	Relaunch	Students open the game on the **same device and browser** as Day 1 and choose "Return to the house." Anyone who finished Night 1 early starts Room 4. On a different computer, students click "Started on another computer?" and load their save file or paste their resume code. Students absent on Day 1 watch the intro with headphones (House map, Replay the intro) before starting.
5-38 min	Play Rooms 4, 5, 6	Students finishing Night 1 first should prioritize Rooms 4 and 5, then the Gauntlet. The Gauntlet's capstone essay needs about 8 minutes.
38-46 min	Debrief	Discuss Scenario 1D: "What secret word or check would your family actually use?" Then 1E: "Why does the AI's fix still go to a human?"

Time	What happens	Teacher moves
46-50 min	Submit	Students download the final PDF and upload it to Canvas before leaving.

Discussion questions for either debrief:

- Which tactic, urgency or intimidation, did you see in more of the messages? Which works better on you?
- In the Midnight Gauntlet log, which single row would you investigate first, and why?
- Where did AI appear on both sides of tonight's attacks, as a weapon and as a defense?

Submission and grading

Students submit one PDF on Canvas, named like `HauntedNetwork_First_Last_P3.pdf`. The game scores 410 points automatically; you score the 6 written responses (4 points each, 24 total).

What the PDF contains:

- Student name, period, start time and report time
- Auto-scored total and percent, per-night and per-room scores
- Every question with its learning objective, the student's answer, the correct answer (for any missed item), and points earned
- Full text of each written response with a blank "Teacher score: ____ / 4" line

How scoring works:

- Each auto-scored challenge is worth 10 points, one submission only.
- Multiple choice, true/false and fill-in-the-blank are all or nothing.
- Select-all, spot-the-phish and log hunts give credit for correct picks minus wrong picks, divided by the number of correct answers, never below 0.
- Matching, sorting and ordering give credit per item in the right place.

Suggested grade: (auto points + written points) / 434. A 2-day review might count as a quiz or classwork grade. If you weight it, consider letting the written responses carry more, since they show application.

If a student cannot download the PDF: the Results page has a Copy report text button with identical content. The student pastes it into a Canvas text entry or a document. As a last resort, accept screenshots of the Results page.

Integrity notes: progress is stored in the student's browser and moves between computers only through a save file or resume code. Saves are checksummed, so an edited save is rejected; loaded answers are always re-scored; and the PDF lists every move with its time. Answers lock after submission. The report carries timestamps for each written response, and missed items show the correct answer only after the student submits.

Answer key: Night 1 (Day 1)

Answers below match the game exactly. Letter choices refer to the order shown on screen (A = first option).

Room 1: The Phantom Postmaster (Topic 1.1)

#	Type	LO	Correct answer	Why it matters
1	Spot the phish	1.1.A	Flag 6 lines: the From line (canvas-instruct0r.net), the Subject (FINAL WARNING, 60 minutes), "Dear Student," the grades-erased threat, the password + 6-digit code request, the disguised link. Do **not** flag: the To line, "Thank you for using Canvas," the sign-off.	Look-alike domain, urgency, generic greeting, intimidation, elicitation of an OTP, mismatched link.
2	Sort it	1.1.A	Urgency: "Only 3 spots left," "Link expires at midnight," "Respond in 15 minutes." Intimidation: "Report you to the police," "Suspension and loss of files," "Tell your principal." Neither: "Notes from the club meeting."	Urgency invents a deadline; intimidation threatens a consequence (1.1.A.2).
3	Multiple choice	1.1.A	B. Elicitation	Tricking someone into revealing sensitive info (1.1.A.1).
4	True/false	1.1.A	False	Also in person, text, social media, phone.

#	Type	LO	Correct answer	Why it matters
5	Multiple choice	1.1.B	C. It pressures people to act before considering whether the action is reasonable or safe	1.1.B.3.
6	Select all	1.1.C	Birthdate, first pet's name, workplace or school, home address	Common challenge-question answers (1.1.C.1).
7	Multiple choice	1.1.C	A. The adversary can log in to the service as the victim	1.1.C.2.
8	Written	1.1.A-C	See rubric W1	

Room 2: The Crypt of Cracked Credentials (Topic 1.2)

#	Type	LO	Correct answer	Why it matters
1	Log hunt	1.2.A	Flag rows 2-6 (Sat 03:12, 185.220.101.4, python-requests, 4 failures then a success) and row 8 (Mon 10:47, unknown IP and device, during school). Do **not** flag rows 1, 7, 9, 10.	Burst of failures + unusual time + unknown device. Rows 9-10 are one typo at home.
2	Select all	1.2.A	Many failed attempts in a short duration; unusual times; unknown devices	The fourth option is false: not every login came from home.
3	Sort it	1.2.B	Strong: t7#Qv9!mLz2@pX4rW, lantern-gravel-oyster-mitten-cobalt, velvet-cactus-thunder-ladle-91. Weak: Biscuit2009!, Halloween26!, MomBday0412, Jackson15$	Weak ones follow word + 2-digit number + symbol, names, or dates (1.2.B.1).
4	Multiple choice	1.2.B	A. Pepper2008!	Dictionaries are built from pet names and birth years (1.2.B.2).

#	Type	LO	Correct answer	Why it matters
5	Put in order	1.2.B	1 Gather personal details, 2 Build dictionary, 3 Load automated tool, 4 Tool submits guesses, 5 Match and log in	
6	Fill in the blank	1.2.C	manager (also accepts "password manager")	1.2.C.1.
7	Multiple choice	1.2.C	B. Multifactor authentication requiring a one-time code	1.2.C.3.
8	Written	1.2.A-C	See rubric W2	

Room 3: The Fog-Bound Cafe (Topic 1.3)

#	Type	LO	Correct answer	Why it matters
1	Multiple choice	1.3.C	C. Sunshine Coffee Wi-Fi (exact match, with hyphen and spaces)	Near-matches are evil twins (1.3.C.1). Common miss: A, "WiFi" without the hyphen.
2	Matching	1.3.B	Evil twin = look-alike SSID access point; Jamming = strong EM signal causing DoS; War driving = detecting beacons while moving around a target; Zero day = undocumented vulnerability	1.3.B.1-3, 1.3.A.1.
3	Sort it	1.3.A	Low-skilled: buys a ready-made kit; uses a purchased exploit for a known bug. High-skilled: finds an undocumented router flaw; modifies malware to evade defenses; writes a new tool from scratch	1.3.A.1.
4	Multiple choice	1.3.A	A. Revenge	1.3.A.2.

#	Type	LO	Correct answer	Why it matters
5	True/false	1.3.B	False	The evil twin cannot read HTTPS traffic (1.3.B.1).
6	Multiple choice	1.3.B	C. A jamming attack, a type of denial of service	1.3.B.2.
7	Multiple choice	1.3.C	C. The VPN provider	1.3.C.3.
8	Select all	1.3.C	Verify the exact network name; consider data sensitivity before joining unencrypted Wi-Fi; use a VPN for sensitive data	Distractors: strongest signal, typing platform passwords into captive portals.
9	Written	1.3.C	See rubric W3	

Answer key: Night 2 (Day 2)

Room 4: The Doppelganger's Call (Topic 1.4)

#	Type	LO	Correct answer	Why it matters
1	Put in order	1.4.A	1 Fake friend request, 2 You accept, 3 Voice samples scraped, 4 Fed into voice-cloning tool, 5 Relative found on social media, 6 Call with fake jail story, 7 Money wired	Scenario 1D attack chain.
2	Multiple choice	1.4.B	C. A secret word or phrase agreed on in advance	Caller ID and voices can be faked (1.4.B.1).
3	Select all	1.4.A	Voice/face cloning; fluent phishing in any language; AI reconnaissance; publishing false info for LLM training sets; AI help writing malware or finding vulnerabilities	Distractor: "adding grammar mistakes" is backwards (1.4.A.1-6).

#	Type	LO	Correct answer	Why it matters
4	True/false	1.4.A	False	LLMs remove the unnatural language cue (1.4.A.2).
5	Multiple choice	1.4.A	B. Get false information into LLM training sets	1.4.A.4.
6	Sort it	1.4.B	Fine to ask: explain an evil twin attack; photosynthesis question; essay draft with no personal details. Keep it out: password list; home address and schedule; employer's customer database	1.4.A.3, 1.4.B.3.
7	Multiple choice	1.4.B	B. Multifactor authentication requiring a second factor	1.4.B.2.
8	Multiple choice	1.4.B	C. Verify with a reputable, stable, non-AI source	1.4.B.4.
9	Written	1.4.B	See rubric W4	

Room 5: The Watchtower (Topic 1.5)

#	Type	LO	Correct answer	Why it matters
1	Log hunt (code)	1.5.A	Flag line 3 and line 10. Do **not** flag line 8.	Lines 3 and 10 paste raw user input into the database command. Line 8 passes the value separately with a `?` placeholder, the kind of fix the AI recommended in Scenario 1E.
2	Matching	1.5.A	Firewall rule or access control = Security technician; Code vulnerability fix = Programmer; Detection rule = Detection engineer	1.5.A.1-3.

#	Type	LO	Correct answer	Why it matters
3	True/false	1.5.A	False	Human review, then a testing environment, before deployment.
4	Multiple choice	1.5.B	B. Millions of events a day, too many for people to examine	1.5.B.1.
5	Sort it	1.5.B	Likely malicious: 500 failed logins in 2 minutes; 4 GB upload to unknown server at 3 AM; new admin account at 2 AM from unknown device. Likely harmless: 9:02 AM office login; scheduled 1 AM backup; printer update	1.5.B.2.
6	Select all	1.5.B	Alert human personnel; take a specific corrective action	AI does not guarantee zero false alarms or replace engineers (1.5.B.3).
7	Written	1.5.A	See rubric W5	

Room 6: The Midnight Gauntlet (mixed review)

#	Type	LO	Correct answer	Why it matters
1	Matching	Vocabulary	IoC = sign of suspicious activity suggesting an attack; MFA = extra proof of identity beyond a password; SSID = broadcast name of a wireless network; WAP = device that creates a wireless network; OTP = code for one login that expires; VPN = encrypts traffic to the provider's system; DoS = prevents users from accessing resources; LLM = generative AI producing human-like text	Unit 1 vocabulary.
2	Multiple choice	1.1.C	B. An adversary can use the one-time code to log in to your account	Impersonation + OTP request.
3	Multiple choice	1.3.B	B. War driving	1.3.B.3.
4	Fill in the blank	1.3.A	zero (also accepts "0" and "zero day")	1.3.A.1.
5	Log hunt	1.2.A / 1.5.B	Flag rows 2-5: 12:10 opened g00gle-share.com link; 12:11 password entered on external page; 02:41 login from unknown overseas device; 02:44 mail forwarding rule created. Do **not** flag 07:58 login or 15:30 logout	Phishing click leads to account takeover; the forwarding rule quietly copies mail. Connects Scenario 1A to log analysis.

#	Type	LO	Correct answer	Why it matters
6	Written	Capstone	See rubric W6	

Written response rubrics

Score each of the 6 written responses out of 4 points, one point per required element. Students see the look-fors after submitting, so expect them to reference those elements by name.

Prompt	Point 1	Point 2	Point 3	Point 4
W1 Room 1, Scenario 1A phishing email	First piece of evidence from the email	Second piece of evidence	Names and explains a tactic (urgency or intimidation)	Describes a consequence of clicking
W2 Room 2, Scenario 1B securing the account	First action with a reason	Second action with a reason	Third action with a reason	At least one action is MFA or a long, unique password
W3 Room 3, Scenario 1C single sign-on	A benefit of one platform login	A hazard of one platform login	Explains why the hazard happens (one credential unlocks many services)	How to avoid the malicious network
W4 Room 4, Scenario 1D voice cloning	An action the student takes	An action the relative takes	Explains how the first breaks the attack chain	Explains how the second breaks the attack chain
W5 Room 5, Scenario 1E AI code review	An advantage of AI code review	A disadvantage	Explains why humans review before implementing	Connects to the scenario (input validation, testing environment)
W6 Gauntlet capstone	Identifies the vulnerability	Explains how the adversary exploits it	Names a detection sign (indicator of compromise)	Gives a mitigation that fits the vulnerability

Exemplar 4-point responses

W1 (Scenario 1A). "The email is from do-not-reply@g00gle.com, which uses zeros instead of the letter o, so it is not really Google. The subject says [Urgent!] and the message says the student won't finish their assignment unless you click, which creates urgency so you act before thinking. A real Google sharing request would come from Google's actual domain. If you click, the link could install malware or take you to a fake login page that captures your school password."

W2 (Scenario 1B). "First, I would change my password to a long random one from a password manager, because the attacker already knows my current one. Second, I would turn on MFA, so even if someone guesses my password they still need the code on my phone. Third, I would change the password on any other account where I reused it, because the attacker will try the same password elsewhere."

W3 (Scenario 1C). "Using one platform to log in is convenient because I only need to remember one strong password. The hazard is that if that one login is stolen, the attacker gets into every service linked to it, which is how the music account was taken over. I could have avoided the fake network by checking that the network name exactly matched the sign, 'Sunshine Coffee Wi-Fi,' instead of joining 'Guest Wi-Fi.'"

W4 (Scenario 1D). "I would set up a secret family code word, so if someone calls claiming to be me, my relative can ask for it and the voice clone won't know it. My relative should hang up and call me back on my real number before sending money. The code word breaks the chain at the phone call, and the callback breaks it before the money is wired. I could also make my videos private so there are fewer voice samples to scrape."

W5 (Scenario 1E). "An advantage is that the AI can scan the whole codebase quickly and catch places where user input goes straight into the database, which humans might miss. A disadvantage is that AI can be wrong, either flagging safe code or suggesting a fix that breaks the app. The developers should review the changes because they understand how the application works, and the code still needs to pass a testing environment before going live."

W6 (Capstone, sample on evil twins). "An evil twin attack exploits people's habit of joining any network with a familiar-looking name. The adversary sets up an access point with an SSID like the real one and captures traffic or credentials from people who join it. A sign is a captive portal asking for your main platform login, or a network name that does not exactly match the posted one. To mitigate it, verify the exact network name and use a VPN on public Wi-Fi."

Troubleshooting and differentiation

Most problems come from switching devices or browsers between days, so say "same device, same browser" at the start of both periods.

Problem	Fix
Student can't open the game link	If Canvas shows the file's code or a blank preview, students should use the download button and open the saved file from their Downloads folder. If you use a claude.ai link, the owner must share it first.
Day 1 progress is missing on Day 2	The student switched device or browser, or used a private window. They click "Started on another computer?" and load their save file or paste their resume code. Answers are re-scored on load and the PDF notes the move. No save? They redo Night 1, or submit their Day 1 checkpoint PDF alongside the Day 2 PDF.
Download PDF button does nothing or shows an error	Check the Downloads folder first; the file is named HauntedNetwork_First_Last_P#.pdf. Otherwise use Copy report text and paste into Canvas, or screenshot the Results page.
"The PDF builder did not load"	Only possible on the claude.ai link version, if the school network blocks a library. Reload, use Copy report text, or switch to the HTML file, which has the library built in.
Two students shared one device	Only one game per browser. The second student uses "I'm a different student," which erases the first student's progress, so have the first student download their PDF first.
Student submitted a wrong answer by accident	Answers lock by design. Note it on their PDF and adjust by hand if you choose.
Intro video won't play or has no sound	Check the device volume and that the tab isn't muted. If the network blocks it, play the MP4 file from your computer or Canvas instead. Captions are built into the video, so it still works silently.

Support for students who need it:

- Pair students for Night 1 and have them alternate who controls the device; each still submits their own written responses on Day 2.
- Read the room briefings aloud before students enter. The briefings restate the CED scenarios in plain language.
- Allow the Unit 1 notes during play. The game rewards application, so notes help without giving answers away.
- Students can type written responses in a document first, then paste them in.

Extensions for early finishers:

- Write a new phishing email for a classmate to analyze, labeling each red flag and the tactic it uses.
- Rewrite line 3 or line 10 of the Watchtower code in plain English as a safe version, explaining what changed.
- Design a family "secret word" plan for Scenario 1D, including what to do if the code word is forgotten.